Day 13 - Tews Falls, Glen Ferguson, Sydenham Lookout

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Iroquoia section · hike 19 · Spencer Gorge (Tew Falls & Dundas Peak)

8.8 km / 5.5 mi	~2.7 h	4.3 km new	52 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

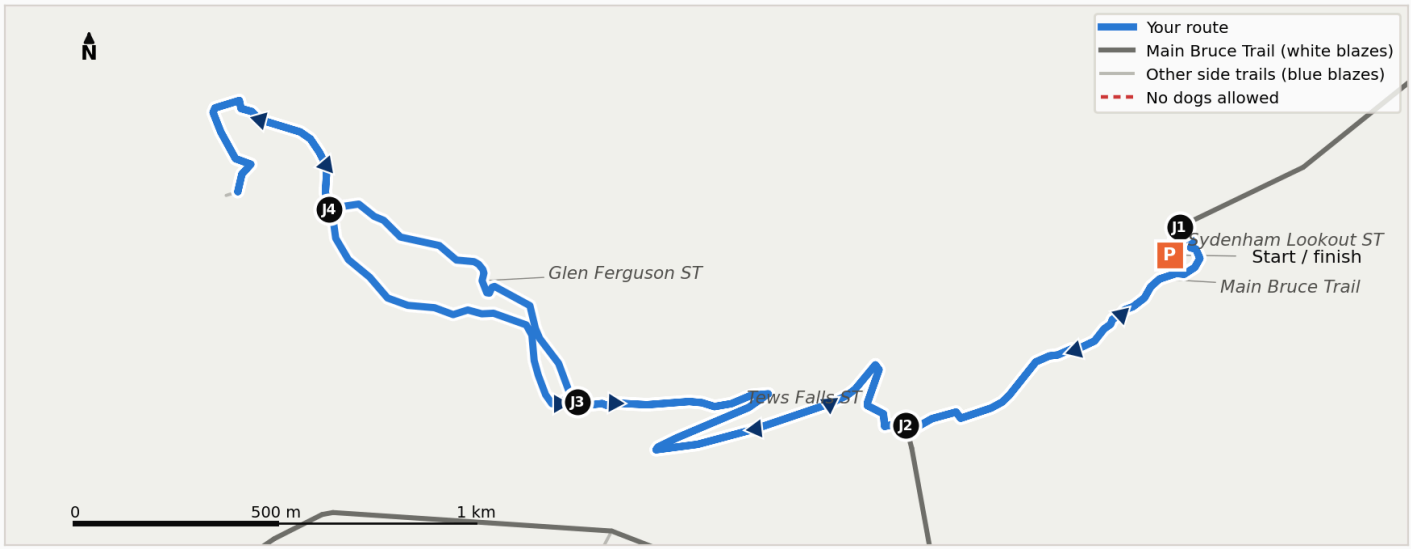
Park: Off road parking at the lookout on Sydenham Rd. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day13_hike019.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Tews Falls Side Trail (3.3 km); Glen Ferguson Side Trail (0.9 km); Sydenham Lookout Side Trail (0.1 km)

Route map

Day 13 | 8.8 km (5.5 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** Off-road at the lookout on Sydenham Rd. HCA's Spencer Gorge lots need a reservation ($11 per vehicle plus $5.50 per passenger and a $10 booking fee); this route starts outside the gorge instead.
- **Road walking:** The Sydenham Lookout Side Trail and two stretches of the main trail follow road shoulders. Keep Zappy close.
- **Tews Falls Side Trail:** Leads to Tew Falls, where Logie's Creek drops 41 m into the gorge. There are two viewing platforms (the upper one by stairs), then an uphill trail to Dundas Peak with views of Hamilton Harbour, Dundas and Cootes Paradise.
- **Glen Ferguson Side Trail:** About 1 km of moderate inclines and uneven ground. It branches off the Tews Falls trail and rejoins it near Dundas Peak, so the route weaves between the two.
- **Cautions and dogs:** HCA requires pets on leash and picked up after. Keep at least a body length back from gorge and escarpment edges, stay on marked trails, and do not go to the bottom of the falls.
- **Main Bruce Trail:** Escarpment-edge walking over the Dundas Valley, with roots, rocks and possible mud after rain.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Off road parking at the lookout on Sydenham Rd. Head north on the blue-blazed Sydenham Lookout Side Trail. The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
0.1	0.0	J1: Turn sharp right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
0.7	0.4	Heads-up: The next 0.4 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
1.1	0.7	J2: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Tews Falls Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
2.8	1.7	J3: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Tews Falls Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Glen Ferguson Side Trail goes off on your right.)
3.7	2.3	J4: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Tews Falls Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Glen Ferguson Side Trail goes off on your right.)

5.1	3.2	J4: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Glen Ferguson Side Trail, heading east. (the Tews Falls Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
6.0	3.7	J3: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Tews Falls Side Trail, heading east. (the Tews Falls Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
7.7	4.8	J2: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
7.7	4.8	Heads-up: The next 0.4 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
8.7	5.4	J1: Turn sharp left onto the blue-blazed Sydenham Lookout Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.) The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
8.8	5.5	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on HCA, Hiking Project and a club hike listing.